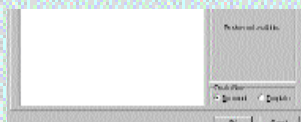


the Document Map (from the View menu) to browse through the sections and sub-sections. The items are grouped according to the hierarchy, and you can show or hide any of the levels (to see all sections at one glance, for example), making it extremely simple to navigate the document. Another advantage of using styles is that it makes reorganisation very simple. Switch to Outline View (**View > Outline**). Here, the entire document is displayed in a hierarchical form. Each group can be collapsed or expanded. You can click on the marker next to the heading or paragraph and drag it up, down, left or right. Pulling it up or down will move the entire group and its subgroups above or below other items, pulling it left or right will promote or demote the group. For a quick glance at the sections, click the Show First Line Only icon on the toolbar. This will display only the first line of every paragraph, again making it extremely simple to navigate a document.

Another advantage of using these styles in your document is that it can be imported directly into PowerPoint to make a presentation.

❗ Oops! This logo on the letterhead is for the wrong department. Now I'll have to print all the copies again.

You can avoid mix-ups and ensure consistency for all office memos by using templates. It is extremely



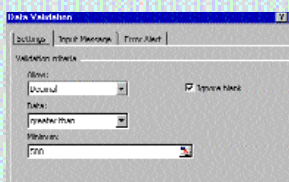
Templates ensure consistency

simple to create and use them. Open any existing document, delete all the matter except the items you want to repeat across all memos (logos, headers, footers, etc) and click **File > Save As** and choose Document Template from the 'Save as type' list. Apart from repeating items, templates also maintain styles, so you can ensure consistency in the fonts, headings, etc. Create a template for every kind of document you want to maintain and every time you want to create a new document, click **File > New** and choose which one you want to use. You can even replace the New icon on the toolbar with the one from **File > New**.

❗ We dispatch several hundred units across 20 regions. It takes me half a day every week to decide on the correct distribution plan and to make reports for region-wise break-ups.

Excel can be very useful for small-time inventory tracking. Plus, you don't need to know too much about Excel to be able to use it—basic inventory tracking simply involves addition, subtraction, multiplication and division. As a one-time exercise, you can make a worksheet that has all the functions

defined. You can probably use one sheet to keep a tab on all products. Thus, if you have all the products listed in one column, the total number of products in another column and the regions across a row, all you have to do is punch in the right numbers in the right cells. If you want an estimate of how many pieces of each to send to each region, just fill in the cells with the percentage of products you send to that region from the total number of products (e.g., =B3*12%) and every time the total number of products changes,



Automatic validation in Excel

you will automatically get the new estimate.

When filling up the sheet, if the number of products exceed the total number, or if a particular region is receiving very few products, you can have Excel warn you about it by using conditional formatting. Select the cells for which you want the warnings, click **Format > Conditional Formatting** and select 'Cell Value Is' in the first drop down, less than in the second drop down and enter the threshold value in the text area. Click the Format button to set the formatting. You can add up to three such conditions. If

you simply want to highlight negative numbers, open **Format > Cells**, under the Number tab set Category to Number and choose a style for negative numbers.

Again, rather than simply formatting such discrepancies, you can have Excel throw up an error message. Click **Data > Validation** and choose 'Allow Decimal with data greater than' and enter the minimum value the cell should have. Under the Error Alert tab, enter an error message to be displayed every time the data does not match the criteria.

Creating reports and graphs from this data is a breeze. Just click the Chart Wizard icon on the toolbar and click through the screens. You can link the data from Excel into Word too, say for creating vouchers for the products that are being sent to every region, by using Word's Mail Merge feature.

❗ The directory is in a Word file, but they haven't even used tables. How do I copy just the names of all the people at one go?

You can select a column of text out from a chunk in Word, just as in Acrobat Reader. Press [Alt] while dragging a selection around the text that you want to copy and only that part will be copied. This is extremely useful for picking out information from documents where items have been separated by a number of spaces or tabs. **■**